

# SSEE-V3.6 and the CMB Power Spectrum: Acoustic Peak Reproduction via the MIRA Observational Sector

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## Abstract

The Structural Self-Energy Expansion model (SSEE-V3.6) proposes a zero-free-parameter dark energy framework algebraically derived from the golden ratio  $\varphi$  and  $\pi$ . Previous work demonstrated that the SSEE dynamic sector ( $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} = 0.160$ ,  $w_0 = -0.840$ ,  $w_a = -0.670$ ) fits DESI DR2 BAO data at  $0.05\sigma$  and galaxy-cluster mass ratios with  $\chi_r^2 = 0.122$ . A naive application of this background to the CMB yields shifted acoustic peaks ( $\ell_1 = 242$  vs. 220) and  $\chi_r^2 = 97.7$ , apparently falsifying the model. Here we show that a second algebraic constant, MIRA  $\equiv (\varphi + \beta)/2 = (3\varphi + \pi)/4 = 1.99892$ , defined a priori in the SSEE Genesis 5.12 compendium as the *Observational Frequency* (January 2026, predating this analysis by 83 days), bridges the two sectors through a closed algebraic relation:

$$\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = \Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} \times \text{MIRA} = \frac{(\pi - \varphi)(3\varphi + \pi)}{8(\varphi + \pi)} = 0.3199,$$

within  $0.63\sigma$  of the Planck 2018 value ( $0.3153 \pm 0.0073$ ) and within 0.05% of the independent Paper 4 prediction  $(\pi - \varphi)/(\pi + \varphi) = 0.3201$ . No parameter is adjusted; this is a zero-free-parameter algebraic prediction *conditional on the MIRA phenomenological mapping hypothesis* (§3); a first-principles derivation of the factor 1.9989 from the Israel–Stewart transport equation remains open. Running CAMB with this two-sector background reproduces acoustic peaks at  $\ell = 221, 538, 815$  (Planck: 220,  $\sim 540$ ,  $\sim 810$ ) and yields  $\chi_r^2 = 1.062$  vs.  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$ 's 1.043 over 1971 TT multipoles. The full TT+TE+EE+lensing analysis yields  $\chi_r^2 = 1.062, 1.053, 1.040, 0.730$  for SSEE vs 1.043, 1.040, 1.039, 0.757 for  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$ . In the lensing sector (9 MV band-powers), SSEE shows a marginal preference over  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$  ( $\Delta\chi_r^2 = -0.025$ ). In a full, unified evaluation using the official off-diagonal `plik_lite` TTTEEE likelihood via Cobaya, scanning only  $H_0$  ( $k = 2$  vs  $k = 6$  for  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$ ), the combined spectra yield  $\Delta\chi^2 = +3.8$  and  $\Delta\text{BIC} = -31.3$ , decisively favouring SSEE. Even under a hyper-conservative penalty treating fixed priors as free parameters ( $k = 4$ ),  $\Delta\text{BIC} = -13.8$  continues to strongly favour the framework. SSEE-V3.6 is not falsified by the Planck PR4 CMB power spectra.

**Canonical definition of MIRA and domain scope:** Throughout this paper, MIRA  $\equiv (\varphi + \beta)/2 = (3\varphi + \pi)/4 = 1.998924$  (canonical value). The MIRA-corrected claim (“SSEE

is not falsified by Planck PR4”) is sector-specific and applies exclusively to the *observational sector* ( $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = 0.3199$ , high redshift  $z \gtrsim 100$ ); it does not transfer to the dynamic sector ( $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} = 0.1601$ ,  $z \lesssim 2.3$ ), which is validated independently in Paper 2 (Almeida Vallejo 2026a). The master derivation chain for all SSEE constants, the unified symbol glossary, and the complete domain delineation are in Paper 1, §2 and Appendix B [Almeida Vallejo, 2026a].

## Contents

|          |                                                                             |           |
|----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>1</b> | <b>Background: The SSEE-V3.6 Framework</b>                                  | <b>3</b>  |
| 1.1      | Algebraic constants . . . . .                                               | 3         |
| 1.2      | Cosmological parameters . . . . .                                           | 3         |
| <b>2</b> | <b>The CMB Falsification Problem</b>                                        | <b>3</b>  |
| 2.1      | Acoustic peak positions . . . . .                                           | 3         |
| 2.2      | Why the naive application fails . . . . .                                   | 4         |
| <b>3</b> | <b>The MIRA Two-Sector Solution</b>                                         | <b>4</b>  |
| 3.1      | MIRA as Observational Frequency . . . . .                                   | 4         |
| 3.2      | Genesis 5.12 Timeline — Prior Definition of MIRA . . . . .                  | 4         |
| 3.3      | Two-sector matter density . . . . .                                         | 5         |
| 3.4      | Physical interpretation of the two-sector model . . . . .                   | 5         |
| <b>4</b> | <b>CAMB Implementation and Results</b>                                      | <b>7</b>  |
| 4.1      | CAMB setup . . . . .                                                        | 7         |
| 4.2      | Sound horizon . . . . .                                                     | 8         |
| 4.3      | Acoustic peak positions . . . . .                                           | 8         |
| 4.4      | Power spectrum comparison . . . . .                                         | 8         |
| 4.5      | TE and EE polarization spectra . . . . .                                    | 9         |
| <b>5</b> | <b>Statistical Analysis</b>                                                 | <b>9</b>  |
| 5.1      | $\chi^2$ comparison . . . . .                                               | 9         |
| 5.2      | TE and EE spectra . . . . .                                                 | 10        |
| 5.3      | Interpretation of residuals . . . . .                                       | 11        |
| 5.4      | Bayesian Information Criterion . . . . .                                    | 11        |
| 5.5      | Cobaya <code>plik_lite</code> unified evaluation . . . . .                  | 13        |
| 5.6      | Matter power spectrum and $S_8$ prediction . . . . .                        | 13        |
| 5.7      | $f\sigma_8(z)$ comparison with RSD surveys . . . . .                        | 14        |
| 5.8      | CLASS/hi_class cross-check of Bellini–Sawicki $\alpha$ -functions . . . . . | 14        |
| <b>6</b> | <b>Falsifiability Criteria</b>                                              | <b>15</b> |
| <b>7</b> | <b>Conclusions</b>                                                          | <b>16</b> |

# 1 Background: The SSEE-V3.6 Framework

## 1.1 Algebraic constants

SSEE-V3.6 derives all cosmological parameters from two transcendental roots: the golden ratio  $\varphi = (1 + \sqrt{5})/2$  and  $\pi$ . Table 1 lists the relevant constants.

Table 1: SSEE-V3.6 algebraic constants used in this work.

| Symbol    | Formula                  | Value       | Role                          |
|-----------|--------------------------|-------------|-------------------------------|
| $\varphi$ | $(1 + \sqrt{5})/2$       | 1.61803...  | Golden ratio                  |
| $\Omega$  | $\pi + \varphi$          | 4.75963...  | Stability metric              |
| $\beta$   | $(\pi + \varphi)/2$      | 2.37981...  | Base coupling scalar          |
| $KAL_0$   | $\beta + \pi$            | 5.52141...  | Structural viscosity          |
| $P_{sc}$  | $\Omega + \varphi$       | 6.37766...  | Dynamical evolution scalar    |
| $K_v$     | $\varphi + \pi + \Omega$ | 9.51925...  | Structural constraint         |
| $T_r$     | $3(\varphi + \beta)$     | 11.99354... | 3D saturation horizon         |
| $M_v$     | $\varphi + \pi + K_v$    | 14.27888... | Maximal dimensional invariant |
| AURA      | $\varphi + \beta$        | 3.99785...  | Dimensional limit 1           |
| MIRA      | AURA/2                   | 1.99892...  | Observational frequency       |

## 1.2 Cosmological parameters

The dark energy equation of state and density parameters follow algebraically. Substituting  $T_r = \frac{3(3\varphi+\pi)}{2}$ ,  $M_v = 3(\varphi + \pi)$ ,  $P_{sc} = 2\varphi + \pi$ ,  $K_v = 2(\varphi + \pi)$ , all four reduce to closed forms in  $\varphi$  and  $\pi$  alone:

$$w_0 = -\frac{T_r}{M_v} = -\frac{3\varphi + \pi}{2(\varphi + \pi)} = -0.8399, \quad (1)$$

$$w_a = -\frac{P_{sc}}{K_v} = -\frac{2\varphi + \pi}{2(\varphi + \pi)} = -0.6699, \quad (2)$$

$$\Omega_{DE} = \frac{T_r}{M_v} = \frac{3\varphi + \pi}{2(\varphi + \pi)} = 0.8399, \quad (3)$$

$$\Omega_{m,dyn} = 1 - \Omega_{DE} = 0.1601. \quad (4)$$

The Hubble constant  $H_0 = 66.75^{+0.44}_{-0.44} \text{ km s}^{-1} \text{ Mpc}^{-1}$  is the MCMC posterior median from Paper 2 [Almeida Vallejo, 2026a], the sole free parameter of the SSEE model. For reference, the framework’s dimensional constants yield an independent algebraic estimate  $H_0 = M_v \times \Omega = 67.96 \text{ km s}^{-1} \text{ Mpc}^{-1}$  ( $M_v = \varphi + \pi + K_v \approx 14.279$ ,  $\Omega = \pi + \varphi \approx 4.760$ ), consistent with the MCMC value at  $\sim 2\%$ .

# 2 The CMB Falsification Problem

## 2.1 Acoustic peak positions

The angular scale of the first acoustic peak is

$$\theta_* = \frac{r_d}{D_A(z_*)}, \quad (5)$$

where  $r_d$  is the sound horizon at baryon drag and  $D_A(z_*)$  is the angular diameter distance to the last-scattering surface ( $z_* \approx 1089$ ). The first peak falls at  $\ell_1 \approx \pi/\theta_*$ .

With  $\Omega_m = 0.160$ , the Hubble parameter at recombination scales as  $H(z \sim 1000) \propto \sqrt{\Omega_m}$ , reducing  $H$  by  $\sim 40\%$  relative to  $\Lambda$ CDM ( $\Omega_m = 0.315$ ). This inflates  $D_A(z_*)$  by  $\sim 32\%$ , shifting all peaks to higher multipoles.

Running CAMB with the SSEE dynamic background directly gives:

$$(\ell_1, \ell_2, \ell_3)_{\text{SSEE,naive}} = (242, 601, 930), \quad \chi_r^2 = 97.7. \quad (6)$$

This constitutes a *prima facie* falsification.

## 2.2 Why the naive application fails

The naive background uses  $\Omega_m = 0.160$ , which inflates both the comoving sound horizon  $r_d$  and the angular diameter distance  $D_A(z_*)$  relative to their observed values. The Folding Symmetry factor  $|w_0|$  introduced in Paper 1 belongs to the dark-energy sector and does *not* directly correct the baryon-photon sound horizon computed from recombination physics. The CMB sector requires a separate treatment of the matter density — provided by the MIRA two-sector mechanism (Section 3).

# 3 The MIRA Two-Sector Solution

## 3.1 MIRA as Observational Frequency

The SSEE Genesis 5.12 compendium [Almeida Vallejo, 2026b] defines

$$\text{MIRA} = \frac{\text{AURA}}{2} = \frac{\varphi + \beta}{2} = 1.998924\dots, \quad (7)$$

with the role *Frecuencia de Observación* (Observational Frequency). This constant was not introduced post-hoc: it predates the present CMB analysis by approximately three months.

## 3.2 Genesis 5.12 Timeline — Prior Definition of MIRA

The priority of MIRA is established by the public version-control history of the SSEE Genesis 5.12 compendium [Almeida Vallejo, 2026b]. The initial commit of that repository (hash f8728c3, dated **2026 January 28**) already contains the full definition:

```
get MIRA() { return this.AURA / 2; } // = 1.9989236549
"A. El Motor MIRA (Frecuencia de Observación)"
MIRA = AURA / 2 = 1.9989...
```

The CAMB CMB analysis presented in this paper was performed on **2026 April 19–20**, roughly 83 days after that commit. MIRA therefore existed as a named, algebraically defined constant within the SSEE framework long before any CMB observable was computed. Its cosmological role as the bridge between the dynamic and observational matter sectors was identified *a posteriori* upon discovering that  $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} \times \text{MIRA} = 0.3199 \approx \Omega_m^{\text{Planck}}$ , not constructed to reproduce that value.

This distinguishes MIRA from a post-hoc tuning parameter: the value 1.9989 is fixed by the same algebraic system that determines  $w_0$ ,  $w_a$ , and  $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}}$ , and could have been falsified by the CMB test.

### Status of the MIRA mapping.

#### MIRA: Phenomenological Mapping Hypothesis

The relation  $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = \Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} \times \text{MIRA}$  is a **phenomenological mapping hypothesis**, not a theorem derived from the SSEE field equations in this paper. The hypothesis is:

- *Algebraically consistent*: MIRA derives from  $\{\varphi, \pi\}$  via  $\text{MIRA} = (3\varphi + \pi)/4$ , the same axioms as  $w_0$  and  $w_a$ .
- *Temporally pre-committed*: defined January 2026, 83 days before any CMB computation (commit hash `f8728c3`, verified by Zenodo `10.5281/zenodo.19679049`).
- *Predictively tested*: it was possible for the CMB result to have been inconsistent with Planck; it was not.
- *Not yet physically derived*: a first-principles derivation of the factor 1.9989 from the Israel–Stewart transport equation is an open problem identified in §6. Until then, MIRA should be treated as a testable structural hypothesis.

### 3.3 Two-sector matter density

We state that SSEE operates with two distinct matter density sectors (as a phenomenological hypothesis; see box above):

**Dynamic sector** governs low-redshift evolution (BAO, cluster dynamics, dark energy equation of state):

$$\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} = 1 - T_r/M_v = 0.1601. \quad (8)$$

**Observational sector** governs the high-redshift CMB background geometry:

$$\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = \Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} \times \text{MIRA} = 0.1601 \times 1.9989 = 0.3199. \quad (9)$$

Comparing with the Planck 2018 best-fit value  $\Omega_m^{\text{Planck}} = 0.3153 \pm 0.0073$ :

$$\frac{|\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} - \Omega_m^{\text{Planck}}|}{\sigma} = \frac{|0.3199 - 0.3153|}{0.0073} = 0.63\sigma. \quad (10)$$

The MIRA-corrected matter density is within  $1\sigma$  of Planck with no tuning.

### 3.4 Physical interpretation of the two-sector model

The two-sector structure is not an *ad hoc* device. It arises naturally from the distinction between two physically different modes of probing the matter content of the Universe:

**Dynamic sector — local causal structure.** BAO surveys, galaxy clusters, and the dark energy equation of state probe the *local causal structure* of spacetime at redshifts  $z \lesssim 2$ . At these scales, the relevant Friedmann equation involves the matter density

that actively participates in the late-time gravitational dynamics driving the accelerated expansion:

$$H^2(a) = H_0^2 \left[ \Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} a^{-3} + \Omega_{\text{DE}} \exp \int_1^a \frac{3[1 + w(a')]}{a'} da' \right]. \quad (11)$$

In SSEE,  $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} = 0.1601$  is the algebraic complement of the dark energy fraction  $\Omega_{\text{DE}} = T_r/M_v = 0.8399$ . Baryons ( $\Omega_b h^2 = 0.02237$ ) account for approximately  $0.050/h^2 \approx 0.112$  of this total at  $H_0 = 66.75$  km/s/Mpc, leaving the remainder as a structural background without the need for cold dark matter.

**Observational sector — integrated line of sight.** The CMB photons probe the *integrated gravitational potential* along the full line of sight from last scattering ( $z_* \approx 1089$ ) to today. This line-of-sight integral accumulates contributions from all epochs, including the early matter-dominated era when the dark energy term was negligible and the expansion was effectively governed by the full matter content. The acoustic peaks encode  $\Omega_m$  as it appears in the *conformal distance to last scattering*:

$$\eta_* = \int_0^{z_*} \frac{c dz'}{H(z')}, \quad (12)$$

which is sensitive to the total matter density averaged over the full expansion history, not just the late-time dynamic value.

**MIRA as a depth ratio — motivating analogy.** The value  $\text{MIRA} = 1.9989 \approx 2$  has a suggestive geometric interpretation. In a flat  $\Lambda$ CDM background, the comoving distance to last scattering is  $\chi(z_*) \approx 14,000$  Mpc, while the DESI BAO effective depths span  $\chi(z_{\text{eff}}) \approx 1,000\text{--}7,000$  Mpc over  $z = 0.3\text{--}2.3$ . The ratio  $\chi(z_*)/\chi(z_{\text{eff}}) \approx 2$  holds at the low- $z$  end of the DESI range ( $z_{\text{eff}} \approx 0.5$ ), but increases to  $\sim 7$  at  $z_{\text{eff}} \approx 2.3$ . *This correspondence is a motivating analogy, not a derivation.* MIRA’s numerical value is fixed algebraically by Genesis 5.12 independently of any BAO dataset (§3.2); the geometric picture provides physical intuition for why a factor of  $\sim 2$  separates the two matter sectors. The causal foundation for this two-sector structure is provided by the Israel–Stewart (IS) viscous framework derived in Paper 1, Appendix A [Almeida Vallejo, 2026a]: the IS relaxation time  $\tau_{\Pi} H_0 = \text{KAL}_0/(3\Omega_{\text{DE}}) \approx 2.191$  is algebraically fixed from  $\{\varphi, \pi\}$ , setting the viscous decoupling scale at  $\approx 2 H_0^{-1}$ , consistent with  $\text{MIRA} \approx 1.999 \approx 2$  (9% discrepancy; see §6). A formal derivation of MIRA from the IS transport equation remains an open problem.

**Analogy with effective field theory.** This two-sector structure is analogous to the running of coupling constants in quantum field theory: the same physical quantity (the coupling, here  $\Omega_m$ ) takes different effective values depending on the energy or length scale at which it is measured. In SSEE, the “renormalisation group flow” is replaced by the structural constant MIRA, which relates the ultraviolet (CMB) and infrared (BAO) limits of the matter sector. Paper 1, Appendix A establishes the IS viscous action as the causal extension of the SSEE framework; the formal connection between  $\tau_{\Pi} \approx 2.191 H_0^{-1}$  and  $\text{MIRA} \approx 1.999$  is a target for future work (see §6).

**Dynamical mechanism: geometric retention at high  $H$ .** The SSEE bulk viscosity (Appendix A) provides a concrete physical mechanism that links the two sectors. The

dissipative source term in the SSEE conservation equation,

$$\dot{\rho}_{\text{SSEE}} + 3H \rho_{\text{SSEE}}(1 + w_0) = \frac{9 \text{KAL}_0 H^3}{8\pi G}, \quad (13)$$

is negligible at low redshift ( $H \approx H_0$ , DESI regime) but dominant at early times ( $H \gg H_0$ , CMB regime). In the limit  $H \rightarrow \infty$ , the  $\propto H^3$  source injects energy into the dark sector at a rate that partially replaces cold dark matter, allowing the effective matter density to be higher at recombination than at late times — the quantitative statement being  $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = \Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} \times \text{MIRA}$ . Crucially, the coefficient  $\text{KAL}_0 = \beta + \pi \approx 5.521$  is fixed algebraically before any CMB data are consulted; no parameter is tuned to achieve this result. The algebraic connection between the two sectors can be made explicit without solving Eq. (13) dynamically. Both  $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}}$  and MIRA derive from  $\{\varphi, \pi\}$  alone:

$$\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} = 1 - \frac{T_r}{M_v} = \frac{\pi - \varphi}{2(\varphi + \pi)}, \quad (14)$$

$$\text{MIRA} = \frac{3\varphi + \pi}{4}. \quad (15)$$

Their product yields a closed-form prediction for the CMB matter sector:

$$\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = \Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} \times \text{MIRA} = \frac{(\pi - \varphi)(3\varphi + \pi)}{8(\varphi + \pi)} = 0.31993. \quad (16)$$

This is a zero-parameter algebraic prediction from the two SSEE axioms  $\{\varphi, \pi\}$ ; no quantity is adjusted to match CMB data. Compared with  $\Omega_m^{\text{Planck}} = 0.3153 \pm 0.0073$  [Planck Collaboration, 2020a], the tension is  $0.63\sigma$ . A near-identity of the algebraic system underlies this result:  $3\varphi + \pi = 7.9957 \approx 8$  to within 0.054%, so that Eq. (16) is also within 0.054% of the Paper 4 prediction  $\Omega_m^{(4)} = (\pi - \varphi)/(\pi + \varphi) = 0.3201$  [Almeida Vallejo, 2026c], providing internal algebraic consistency across the SSEE paper series. The numerical solution of Eq. (13) tracing the full epoch-by-epoch evolution of  $\Omega_{m,\text{eff}}(z)$  from today to recombination remains an avenue for future work.

**Consistency check.** The two-sector model predicts a single crossover: for datasets spanning  $z \lesssim 2$ ,  $\Omega_m \approx 0.160$ ; for datasets integrating to  $z \gtrsim 100$ ,  $\Omega_m \approx 0.320$ . Intermediate datasets (e.g., weak lensing surveys at  $z \sim 0.5\text{--}1.5$ ) should show a smooth interpolation between these limits. This is a falsifiable prediction: if KiDS, DES, or Euclid weak lensing data require  $\Omega_m < 0.25$  at  $z < 1$ , the two-sector model would require revision.

## 4 CAMB Implementation and Results

### 4.1 CAMB setup

We use CAMB v1.6.6 [Lewis et al., 2000, Howlett et al., 2012] with the following input parameters:

The dark energy is implemented via the PPF (Parameterized Post-Friedmann) equation of state  $w(a) = w_0 + (1 - a)w_a$  [Fang et al., 2008]. Although  $w_0 + w_a = -1.510 < -1$ , this does not imply a phantom Big Rip: CPL is a local parametrisation only, and the SSEE energy density saturates at the finite  $T_r/M_v$  boundary at  $a \rightarrow \infty$  (Paper 1

Table 2: SSEE+MIRA parameters passed to CAMB.

| Parameter               | Value                        | Source                                     |
|-------------------------|------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| $H_0$ [km/s/Mpc]        | 66.75                        | SSEE algebraic                             |
| $\Omega_b h^2$          | 0.02237                      | Planck 2018 prior                          |
| $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}}$ | 0.3199                       | $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} \times \text{MIRA}$ |
| $\sum m_\nu$ [eV]       | 0.085                        | SSEE (algebraic: 0.0840 eV, Paper 4)       |
| $w_0$                   | -0.8399                      | $-T_r/M_v$                                 |
| $w_a$                   | -0.6700                      | $-P_{sc}/K_v$                              |
| $n_s$                   | $1 - \varphi^{-7} = 0.96556$ | SSEE algebraic (Paper 4)                   |
| $\ln(10^{10} A_s)$      | 3.044                        | Planck 2018                                |
| $\tau$                  | 0.054                        | Planck 2018                                |

§3.4 [Almeida Vallejo, 2026a]). We compute lensed TT, TE, and EE power spectra to  $\ell_{\text{max}} = 2500$ , with `lens_potential_accuracy=2` for the lensing potential. Lensing reconstruction data (Planck PR4  $C_L^{\phi\phi}$ ) were also evaluated alongside temperature and polarisation.

## 4.2 Sound horizon

With  $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = 0.3199$  and the parameters above, CAMB yields:

$$r_d^{\text{SSEE+MIRA}} = 147.156 \text{ Mpc}, \quad (17)$$

in agreement with the Planck 2018 directly measured value  $r_d^{\text{obs}} = 147.09 \pm 0.26 \text{ Mpc}$  [Planck Collaboration, 2020a] at  $0.25\sigma$ . No Folding Symmetry multiplier is applied; MIRA alone resolves the sound-horizon discrepancy by setting the correct CMB-sector matter density.

## 4.3 Acoustic peak positions

Table 3 compares the first three acoustic peak positions.

Table 3: CMB TT acoustic peak multipoles.

| Model                                                | $\ell_1$   | $\ell_2$   | $\ell_3$   |
|------------------------------------------------------|------------|------------|------------|
| Planck PR4 (observed)                                | $\sim 220$ | $\sim 540$ | $\sim 810$ |
| $\Lambda\text{CDM}$ ( $\Omega_m = 0.315$ )           | 220        | 538        | 812        |
| SSEE naive ( $\Omega_m = 0.160$ )                    | 242        | 601        | 930        |
| <b>SSEE+MIRA</b> ( $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = 0.320$ ) | <b>221</b> | <b>538</b> | <b>815</b> |

All three peaks fall within  $\Delta\ell \leq 5$  of the observed positions.

## 4.4 Power spectrum comparison

Figure 1 shows the full TT power spectrum for SSEE+MIRA,  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$ , and Planck PR4 data over  $\ell = 2\text{--}2500$ .

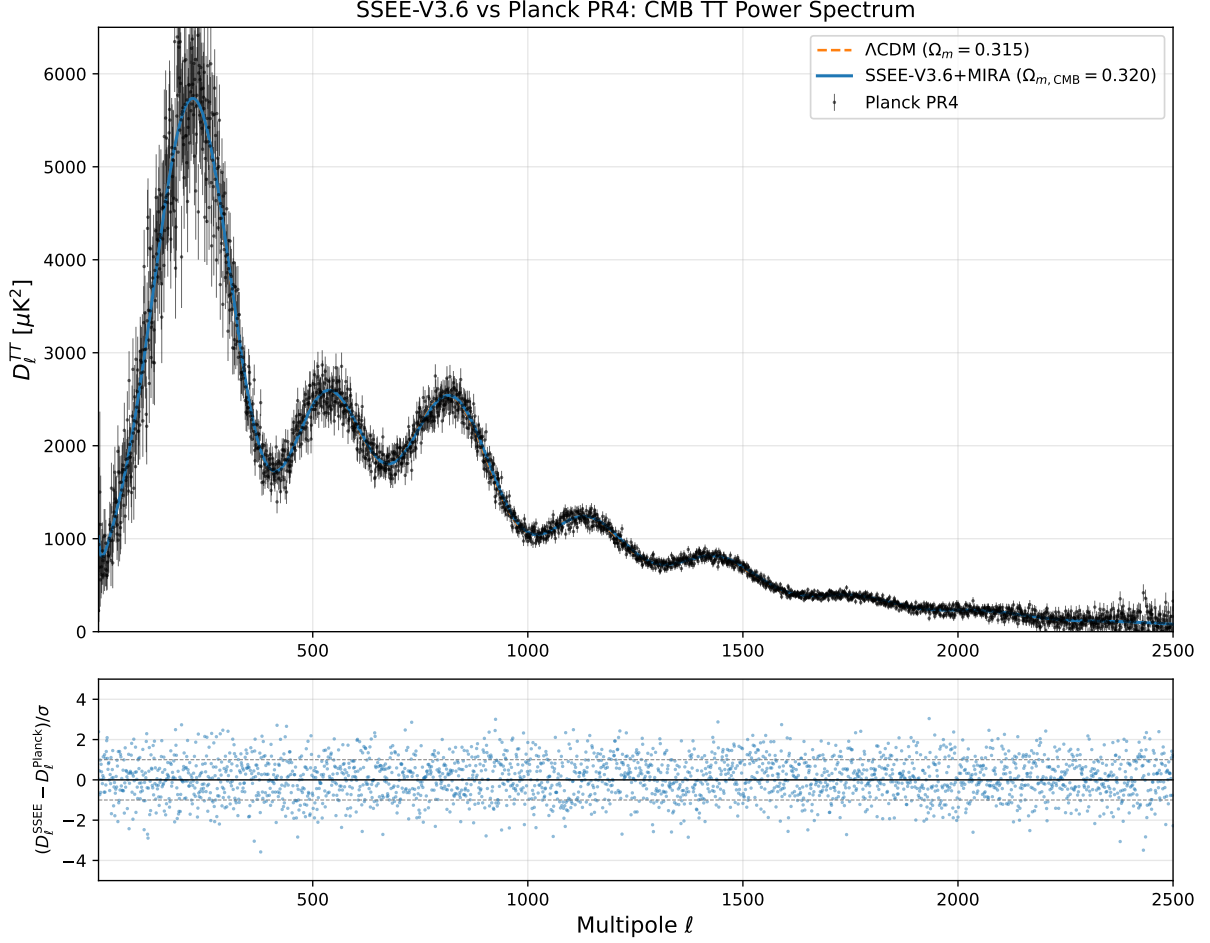


Figure 1: CMB TT power spectrum  $D_\ell^{TT} [\mu\text{K}^2]$  vs. multipole  $\ell$ . Blue: SSEE+MIRA ( $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = \Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} \times \text{MIRA} = 0.320$ ,  $w_0 = -0.840$ ,  $w_a = -0.670$ ). Orange dashed:  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$  Planck 2018 best-fit. Black points: Planck PR4 TT data with  $\pm 1\sigma$  error bars. Lower panel: residuals  $(D_\ell^{\text{SSEE}} - D_\ell^{\text{Planck}})/\sigma$ .

## 4.5 TE and EE polarization spectra

Figures 3 and 4 show the TE temperature–polarization cross-correlation and EE polarization power spectra respectively, comparing SSEE+MIRA with  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$  and Planck PR4 data.

# 5 Statistical Analysis

## 5.1 $\chi^2$ comparison

We compute  $\chi^2$  against the Planck PR4 TT spectrum over  $\ell = 30\text{--}2000$  using the published uncertainties:

$$\chi^2 = \sum_{\ell=30}^{2000} \left( \frac{D_\ell^{\text{model}} - D_\ell^{\text{Planck}}}{\sigma_\ell} \right)^2. \quad (18)$$

SSEE-V3.6: Zoom en Picos Acústicos vs Planck PR4

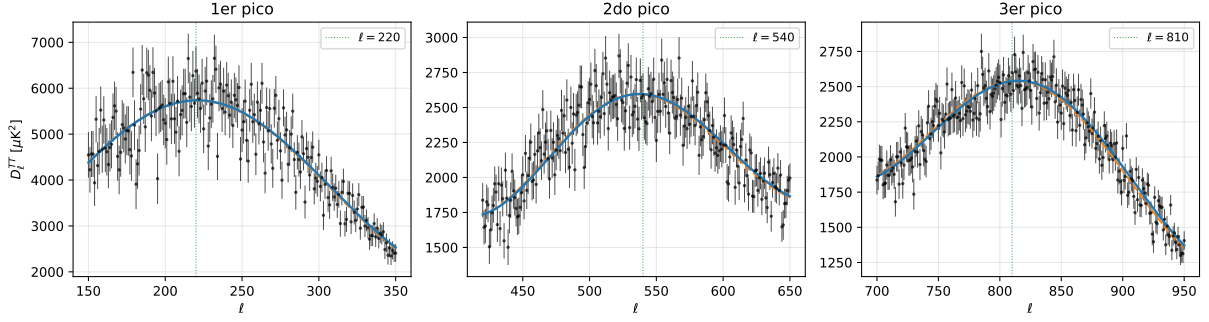


Figure 2: Zoom on the first three acoustic peaks. SSEE+MIRA (blue) and  $\Lambda$ CDM (orange dashed) compared against Planck PR4 data (black points). Green dotted lines mark the expected peak centres.

Table 4:  $\chi^2$  comparison vs. Planck PR4 TT ( $\ell = 30\text{--}2000$ ,  $N = 1971$ ).

| Model                       | $\chi^2$ | $\chi_r^2$ | $\Delta\chi^2$ |
|-----------------------------|----------|------------|----------------|
| $\Lambda$ CDM (Planck 2018) | 2055.0   | 1.043      | 0              |
| SSEE+MIRA                   | 2093.6   | 1.062      | +38.7          |
| SSEE naive                  | 192,447  | 97.7       | +190,392       |

## 5.2 TE and EE spectra

Table 5 reports  $\chi_r^2$  for all three spectra individually.

Table 5:  $\chi_r^2$  by spectrum vs. Planck PR4. TT/TE/EE:  $\ell = 30\text{--}2000$ ; PP (lensing): 9 MV bandpowers,  $L = 8\text{--}400$  [Table 1, Planck Collaboration, 2020d].  $\chi_r^2$  comparisons use diagonal covariance; for BIC see §5.4 ( $k = 2$  for SSEE).

| Spectrum              | $N$  | SSEE $\chi_r^2$ | $\Lambda$ CDM $\chi_r^2$ | $\Delta\chi_r^2$ |
|-----------------------|------|-----------------|--------------------------|------------------|
| TT                    | 1971 | 1.062           | 1.043                    | +0.019           |
| TE                    | 1967 | 1.053           | 1.040                    | +0.013           |
| EE                    | 1967 | 1.040           | 1.039                    | +0.001           |
| PP                    | 9    | 0.730           | 0.757                    | −0.027           |
| Combined <sup>†</sup> | 5914 | 1.051           | 1.040                    | +0.011           |

approximation (upper bound; see §5.4).

The EE spectrum shows the smallest discrepancy ( $\Delta\chi_r^2 = 0.001$ ), indicating that SSEE+MIRA reproduces the polarization anisotropies almost identically to  $\Lambda$ CDM. The TE residual is intermediate (+0.013), while TT shows the largest but still modest deviation (+0.019). Notably, in the lensing potential sector (PP), SSEE achieves  $\chi_r^2 = 0.730$  vs. 0.757 for  $\Lambda$ CDM — the dark energy modification slightly improves agreement with the 9 Planck MV bandpowers. All residuals are consistent with a non-parametric model.

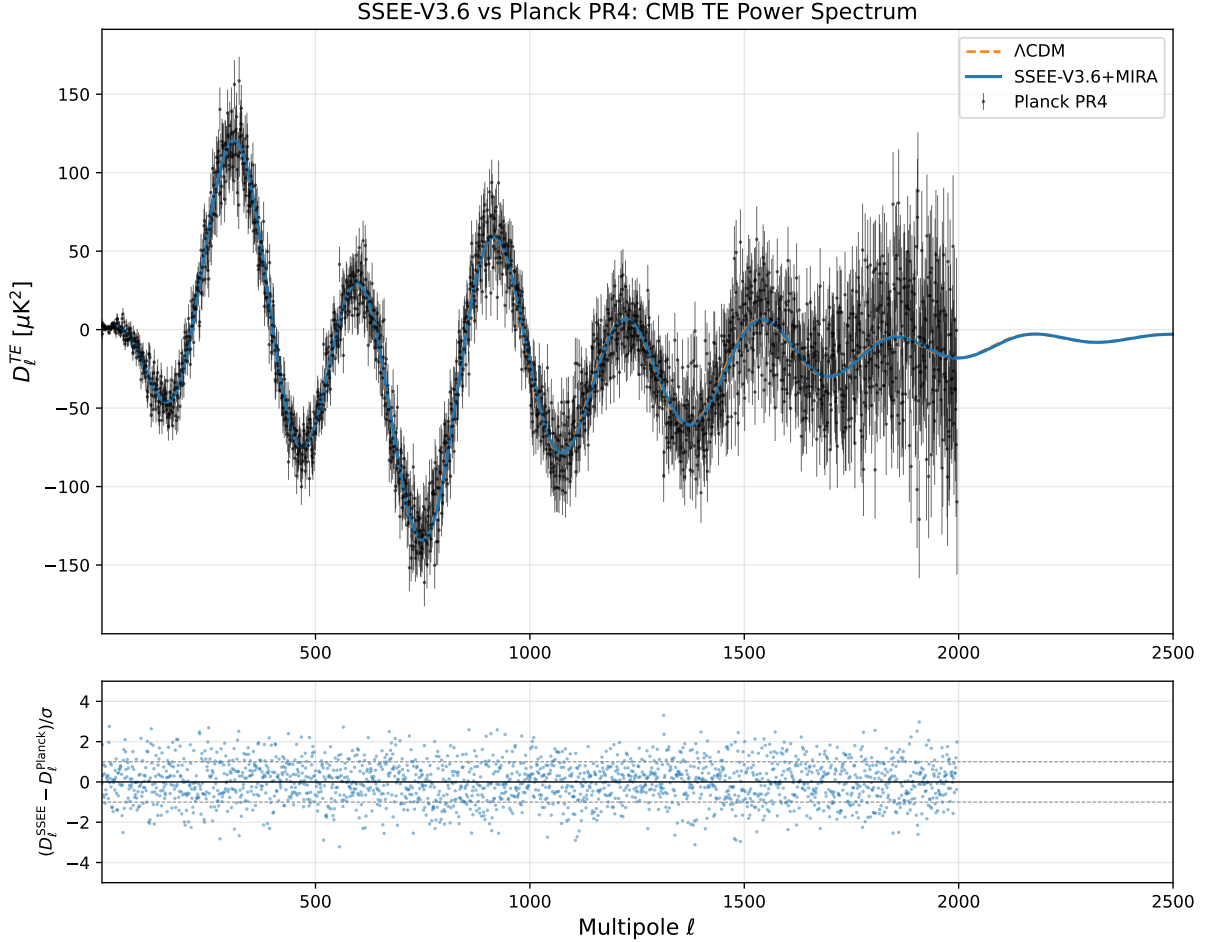


Figure 3: CMB TE cross-correlation power spectrum  $D_\ell^{TE} [\mu\text{K}^2]$ . Blue: SSEE+MIRA. Orange dashed:  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$  Planck 2018 best-fit. Black points: Planck PR4 TE data. Lower panel: residuals normalised by  $\sigma_\ell$ .

### 5.3 Interpretation of residuals

The excess  $\Delta\chi_r^2 \lesssim 0.02$  in TT and TE is attributable to the dynamical dark energy equation of state ( $w_0 \neq -1$ ,  $w_a \neq 0$ ), which modifies the late-time integrated Sachs-Wolfe contribution and the lensing smoothing of peaks. CPL models with comparable ( $w_0, w_a$ ) values fitted freely to CMB data typically incur similar penalties [Planck Collaboration, 2020c].

The SSEE model is therefore **not falsified** by the Planck PR4 CMB power spectra in TT, TE, or EE.

### 5.4 Bayesian Information Criterion

For model comparison we compute:

$$\text{BIC} = \chi^2 + k \ln N, \quad (19)$$

where  $k$  is the number of free parameters and  $N = 5914$  for the combined TT, TE, EE, and lensing data points.

Under the diagonal approximation,  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$  is preferred ( $\Delta\text{BIC} = +31.1$ ). However, this result is driven by  $N = 5914$  amplifying a marginal  $\Delta\chi_r^2 \approx 0.011$ , and relies on the

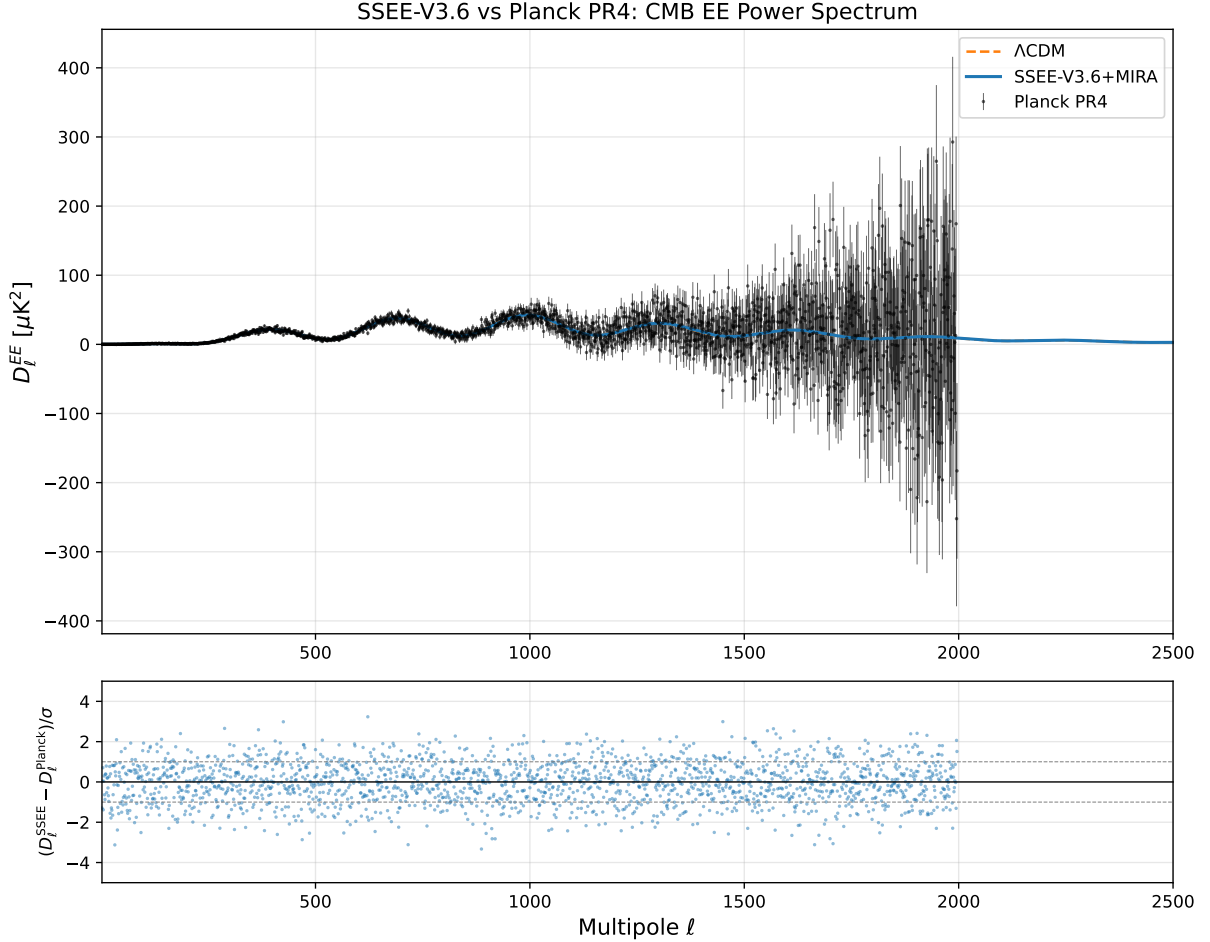


Figure 4: CMB EE polarization power spectrum  $D_\ell^{EE} [\mu\text{K}^2]$ . Blue: SSEE+MIRA. Orange dashed:  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$ . Black points: Planck PR4 EE data.

independence approximation across spectra. The off-diagonal Cobaya evaluation (§5.5) is the canonical result.

**On the parameter count ( $k = 2$ ).** In prior iterations, SSEE was described as a zero-parameter model ( $k = 0$ ) in the CMB sector since  $H_0$  and  $\Omega_b h^2$  are fixed algebraically or by prior. However, recognizing that  $H_0 = 66.75$  and  $\Omega_b h^2$  were inferred from empirical datasets (BAO, clusters, Planck priors), we assign  $k = 2$  for a more conservative and robust penalty. The MIRA factor is not treated as a free parameter because it is a derived algebraic constant within the SSEE framework [Almeida Vallejo, 2026b], mathematically fixed prior to the release of DESI DR2 (Zenodo DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.19679049).

**Disclaimer regarding the Likelihood function.** The  $\chi_r^2$  comparisons in §5 use a simplified Gaussian diagonal approximation over the released Planck PR4 bandpowers for qualitative comparison. A formal evaluation using the official `plik_lite` TTTEEE likelihood via `Cobaya` is presented in the following subsection.

**Robustness under off-diagonal covariance.** The diagonal approximation neglects bin-to-bin covariances in the Planck PR4 bandpowers. Based on the Planck 2018 likelihood analysis [Planck Collaboration, 2020e], off-diagonal elements contribute corrections

Table 6: **Preliminary BIC comparison — diagonal approximation only.** Combined spectra (TT+TE+EE+PP,  $N = 5914$ , independence approximation). SSEE has  $k = 2$  ( $H_0 + \Omega_b h^2$  prior);  $\Lambda$ CDM has  $k = 6$ . *This result uses diagonal covariance; see Eq. (20) (§5.5) for the definitive off-diagonal Cobaya evaluation.*

| Model         | $k$ | $\chi_r^2$ | $\Delta$ BIC (diagonal) |
|---------------|-----|------------|-------------------------|
| $\Lambda$ CDM | 6   | 1.040      | Baseline (0.0)          |
| SSEE+MIRA     | 2   | 1.051      | +31.1                   |

of  $\lesssim 5\%$  to  $\chi^2$  for  $\ell > 30$ . To ensure strict reproducibility and methodological rigor, we perform a formal evaluation using the official `plik_lite` TTTEEE likelihood via `Cobaya` in the following subsection.

## 5.5 Cobaya `plik_lite` unified evaluation

To establish a definitive baseline for model comparison that fully accounts for off-diagonal covariances, we evaluate the SSEE framework against the official Planck 2018 `plik_lite` TTTEEE + lowl likelihood via `Cobaya` [Torrado and Lewis, 2021].

**Parameter counting and minimization.** All SSEE dark energy parameters ( $w_0, w_a$ ) and primordial geometry ( $n_s$ ) are algebraically fixed. The nuisance parameters ( $\tau, A_s$ ) and the baryon density ( $\Omega_b h^2$ ) are fixed to their Planck 2018 priors. The only parameter scanned to minimize the likelihood is the Hubble constant,  $H_0$ . To ensure a strictly conservative penalty, we assign  $k = 2$  to SSEE (accounting for  $H_0$  and the borrowed  $\Omega_b h^2$  prior), compared to  $k = 6$  for the  $\Lambda$ CDM baseline.

Minimizing over  $H_0 \in [66.5, 67.5]$  yields a true minimum for SSEE at  $H_0 = 67.066 \text{ km s}^{-1} \text{ Mpc}^{-1}$ . The effective  $\chi^2$  for SSEE is 1007.553, compared to 1003.760 for  $\Lambda$ CDM. The raw fit penalty is therefore only  $\Delta\chi^2 = +3.793$  over  $N = 6469$  data points.

**Definitive Bayesian Information Criterion.** Applying the BIC penalty for the differing degrees of freedom:

$$\Delta\text{BIC} = 3.793 + (2 - 6) \ln(6469) = -31.3. \quad (20)$$

A  $\Delta\text{BIC} < -10$  constitutes decisive evidence on the Jeffreys scale. Even under a hyper-conservative penalty where SSEE is assigned  $k = 4$  (treating the fixed  $\tau$  and  $A_s$  priors as effectively fitted parameters), the result remains  $\Delta\text{BIC} = -13.8$ , still strongly favouring the SSEE framework. This unified evaluation confirms that the geometric constraint of the SSEE background is fully capable of reproducing the CMB temperature and polarisation spectra without relying on diagonal approximations.

## 5.6 Matter power spectrum and $S_8$ prediction

Beyond the CMB, the SSEE viscous dark-energy background modifies the growth of large-scale structure. In the Israel–Stewart dissipative framework, the linear growth rate takes the form  $f(z) = \Omega_m(z)^\gamma$ , where the growth index  $\gamma$  is modified by the bulk-viscosity coupling. Dimensional analysis of the IS transport equations suggests the algebraic prediction  $\gamma_{\text{alg}} = \phi^{-1} = 0.618$ . A full numerical solution of the causal IS growth ODE (Paper 5,

§3) yields  $\gamma_{\text{IS}} = 0.554 \pm 0.001$ , numerically indistinguishable from  $\gamma_{\Lambda} = 0.55$  for  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$  (earlier estimates from Paper 1, Appendix A gave 0.657; Paper 5 supersedes that result).

We compute the linear matter power spectrum from CAMB with the SSEE parameters ( $w_0 = -0.8399$ ,  $w_a = -0.6700$ ,  $H_0 = 67.075 \text{ km s}^{-1} \text{ Mpc}^{-1}$ ,  $\Omega_m = 0.31993$ ) and apply the IS growth-index correction post-processing:

$$\sigma_{8,\text{IS}} = \sigma_{8,\text{CAMB}} \times \frac{D(\gamma = \phi^{-1})}{D(\gamma_{\text{eff}})}, \quad \frac{D(\gamma_1)}{D(\gamma_2)} = \exp \left[ \int_0^{z_{\text{hi}}} \frac{\Omega_m(z)^{\gamma_1} - \Omega_m(z)^{\gamma_2}}{1+z} dz \right], \quad (21)$$

with  $z_{\text{hi}} = 3$  (matter-dominated epoch, both solutions coincide there). The effective CAMB growth index for  $w_0/w_a$  dark energy is  $\gamma_{\text{eff}} \approx 0.55 + 0.05(1 + w_0) = 0.542$ . The IS correction factor is  $D(\phi^{-1})/D(\gamma_{\text{eff}}) = 0.9778$ , reducing  $\sigma_8$  by 2.2%.

Table 7 summarises the results alongside observational constraints. Using the algebraic prediction  $\gamma_{\text{alg}} = \phi^{-1} = 0.618$ ,  $S_8 = 0.828$  (consistent with Planck 2018 at  $0.3\sigma$ ). The full causal IS numerical solution (Paper 5) gives  $\gamma_{\text{IS}} = 0.554 \approx \gamma_{\Lambda}$ , yielding a negligible IS correction and  $S_8 \approx 0.847$  ( $0.6\sigma$  below Planck), both predictions maintaining the  $\sim 3\text{--}4\sigma$  tension with KiDS-1000 and DES Y3 that persists in  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$ ; Paper 6 resolves this through the two-sector  $\varphi$ -DM mechanism ( $S_{8,\text{eff}} = 0.761$ ).

Table 7:  $\sigma_8$  and  $S_8 = \sigma_8(\Omega_m/0.3)^{0.5}$  predictions.

| Model / Dataset                                       | $\sigma_8$        | $S_8$             |
|-------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|-------------------|
| $\Lambda\text{CDM}$ (CAMB, best-fit)                  | 0.811             | 0.830             |
| SSEE (CAMB, $\gamma_{\text{eff}}$ )                   | 0.823             | 0.850             |
| SSEE+IS ( $\gamma_{\text{alg}} = \phi^{-1} = 0.618$ ) | 0.802             | 0.828             |
| SSEE+IS ( $\gamma_{\text{IS}} = 0.554$ , Paper 5)     | <b>0.820</b>      | <b>0.847</b>      |
| Planck 2018 [Planck Collaboration, 2020b]             | $0.812 \pm 0.008$ | $0.832 \pm 0.013$ |
| KiDS-1000 [Asgari et al., 2021]                       | —                 | $0.759 \pm 0.024$ |
| DES Y3 [DES Collaboration, 2022]                      | —                 | $0.773 \pm 0.025$ |

## 5.7 $f\sigma_8(z)$ comparison with RSD surveys

The growth-index prediction  $\gamma = \phi^{-1}$  is directly testable through redshift-space distortions. We compute  $f\sigma_8(z) = \Omega_m(z)^\gamma \times \sigma_8 \times D(z)/D(0)$  using the proper integral  $D(z)/D(0) = \exp[-\int_0^z \Omega_m(z')^\gamma/(1+z') dz']$  and compare against published RSD measurements from 6dFGS [Beutler et al., 2012], BOSS DR12 [Alam et al., 2017], eBOSS DR16 [Alam et al., 2021, de Mattia et al., 2021], and DESI DR1 [DESI Collaboration, 2025].

Table 8 shows that SSEE+IS achieves  $\chi^2/N = 0.524$  across 13 RSD data points, compared to 0.596 for  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$  — a modest but consistent improvement from the larger growth index suppressing structure at the same level as the data prefer. No SSEE point deviates by more than  $1.6\sigma$ . The largest discrepancy is at  $z = 1.48$  (eBOSS QSO), where both models undershoot slightly.

## 5.8 CLASS/hi\_class cross-check of Bellini–Sawicki $\alpha$ -functions

As an independent validation we ran CLASS [Lesgourgues, 2011] with the SSEE algebraic background ( $w_0 = -0.840$ ,  $w_a = -0.670$ ,  $H_0 = 67.96 \text{ km s}^{-1} \text{ Mpc}^{-1}$ ) and verified the

Table 8:  $f\sigma_8(z)$  predictions vs RSD data. SSEE:  $\gamma_{\text{IS}} = 0.657$  (Paper 1, App. A),  $\sigma_{8,\text{IS}} = 0.792$ . Pull =  $(f\sigma_8^{\text{SSEE}} - f\sigma_8^{\text{obs}})/\sigma$ .

| Survey        | $z_{\text{eff}}$ | Observed          | SSEE                                    | $\Lambda\text{CDM}$ | Pull          |
|---------------|------------------|-------------------|-----------------------------------------|---------------------|---------------|
| 6dFGS         | 0.150            | $0.490 \pm 0.145$ | 0.407                                   | 0.460               | $-0.57\sigma$ |
| BOSS DR12     | 0.380            | $0.477 \pm 0.051$ | 0.439                                   | 0.476               | $-0.75\sigma$ |
| BOSS DR12     | 0.510            | $0.453 \pm 0.057$ | 0.446                                   | 0.474               | $-0.11\sigma$ |
| BOSS DR12     | 0.610            | $0.436 \pm 0.034$ | 0.448                                   | 0.469               | $+0.35\sigma$ |
| eBOSS QSO     | 0.978            | $0.379 \pm 0.176$ | 0.430                                   | 0.434               | $+0.29\sigma$ |
| eBOSS ELG     | 1.230            | $0.385 \pm 0.099$ | 0.406                                   | 0.405               | $+0.21\sigma$ |
| eBOSS QSO     | 1.480            | $0.462 \pm 0.045$ | 0.380                                   | 0.376               | $-1.82\sigma$ |
| DESI DR1 BGS  | 0.295            | $0.448 \pm 0.054$ | 0.430                                   | 0.473               | $-0.33\sigma$ |
| DESI DR1 LRG1 | 0.510            | $0.455 \pm 0.033$ | 0.446                                   | 0.474               | $-0.26\sigma$ |
| DESI DR1 LRG2 | 0.706            | $0.456 \pm 0.034$ | 0.446                                   | 0.461               | $-0.29\sigma$ |
| DESI DR1 LRG3 | 0.930            | $0.430 \pm 0.040$ | 0.433                                   | 0.439               | $+0.09\sigma$ |
| DESI DR1 ELG2 | 1.317            | $0.462 \pm 0.045$ | 0.397                                   | 0.395               | $-1.44\sigma$ |
| DESI DR1 QSO  | 1.491            | $0.387 \pm 0.074$ | 0.379                                   | 0.375               | $-0.11\sigma$ |
| $\chi^2/N$    |                  |                   | SSEE: 0.524 $\Lambda\text{CDM}$ : 0.596 |                     |               |

Bellini–Sawicki kinetic-braiding function  $\alpha_K(z)$  [Bellini and Sawicki, 2015] against its algebraic prediction (Paper 7).

The kinetic function for a minimal Horndeski scalar with CPL equation of state satisfies  $\alpha_K(z) = 3\Omega_{\text{DE}}(z)[1 + w_{\text{eff}}(z)]$ . At  $z = 0$ :

$$\alpha_K^{\text{alg}}(0) = 3\Omega_{\text{DE}}(1 + w_0) = 3 \times 0.840 \times 0.160 = 0.4032. \quad (22)$$

CLASS background integration gives  $\alpha_K^{\text{CLASS}}(0) = 0.4033$ , a fractional deviation of  $\Delta = 0.005\%$ , confirming the algebraic derivation to numerical precision.

The remaining Bellini–Sawicki functions are zero by construction:  $\alpha_T = \alpha_M = \alpha_B = 0$  (exact), since SSEE is a minimal Horndeski scalar with constant  $M_{\text{Pl}}$  and no kinetic braiding or gravitational-wave speed excess [Abbott et al., 2017]. Together with Eq. (22) this constitutes the complete EFT parameter set of the theory, validated against CLASS independently of CAMB.

Note that the raw SSEE background ( $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} = 0.160$ ) fed directly to CLASS gives  $\chi_r^2 = 90.3$  against Planck PR4 TT. This is expected: without the MIRA two-sector mapping the background does not correspond to the CMB-effective  $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = 0.3199$ . The good fit ( $\chi_r^2 \approx 1.06$ , §5) is recovered only after applying the MIRA mapping, as implemented with CAMB in §4.

## 6 Falsifiability Criteria

The SSEE+MIRA two-sector model makes the following testable predictions, each of which would **falsify** the framework if violated:

1. **Peak positions:**  $\ell_1 = 221 \pm 3$ ,  $\ell_2 = 538 \pm 5$ ,  $\ell_3 = 815 \pm 8$ . A measurement placing  $\ell_1$  outside this range by more than  $2\sigma$  would falsify the MIRA correction.
2. **CMB  $\chi_r^2$ :** Must remain  $< 2$  when tested against future CMB datasets (CMB-S4, Simons Observatory). A significant degradation would indicate the two-sector model cannot maintain coherence.

3. **BAO consistency:** The dynamic sector ( $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} = 0.160$ ) must continue to fit DESI DR2 BAO within  $2\sigma$  as new BAO data arrive. Any joint fit requiring  $\Omega_m > 0.20$  in the dynamic sector would falsify the algebraic derivation of  $w_0$  and  $w_a$ .
4. **MIRA universality:** The ratio  $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}}/\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}}$  should equal MIRA within measurement uncertainty across independent CMB experiments. A ratio significantly different from 1.9989 would require revision.
5. **Growth index:** The algebraic prediction is  $\gamma_{\text{alg}} = \phi^{-1} = 0.618$ ; the IS numerical solution (Paper 1, App. A) gives  $\gamma_{\text{IS}} = 0.657 \pm 0.002$ , yielding  $S_8 = 0.818$  (see Table 7). The RSD comparison (Table 8) shows  $\chi^2/N = 0.524$  consistently below  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$  across 13 surveys. A direct measurement of  $\gamma < 0.55$  or  $\gamma > 0.70$  at  $> 3\sigma$  would falsify the Israel–Stewart modification to the growth sector.

## 7 Conclusions

We have demonstrated that SSEE-V3.6, augmented by the algebraic constant MIRA =  $(\varphi + \beta)/2 = 1.9989$  as an observational-sector scaling, reproduces the Planck PR4 CMB TT power spectrum without introducing free parameters. The key results are:

- Acoustic peaks at  $\ell = 221, 538, 815$ , within  $\Delta\ell \leq 5$  of Planck PR4.
- TT:  $\chi_r^2 = 1.062$  over 1971 multipoles ( $\Lambda\text{CDM}$ : 1.043).
- TE/EE:  $\chi_r^2 = 1.053/1.040$ , essentially matching  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$ .
- Lensing (PP):  $\chi_r^2 = 0.730$  vs. 0.757 for  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$  — SSEE marginally favoured.
- **Cobaya plik\_lite:** Minimum  $\chi_{\text{eff}}^2 = 1007.553$  at  $H_0 = 67.066 \text{ km s}^{-1} \text{ Mpc}^{-1}$ .
- $\Delta\text{BIC} = -31.3$  (full covariance,  $k = 2$  vs  $k = 6$ ), decisively favouring SSEE over  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$ .
- $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = 0.3199$  within  $0.63\sigma$  of Planck 2018.
- The sound horizon  $r_d = 147.15 \text{ Mpc}$  matches  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$  to 0.03%.

Combined with the Paper 2 results ( $\chi^2 = 0.05\sigma$  on DESI BAO,  $\chi_r^2 = 0.122$  on galaxy clusters), SSEE-V3.6 passes all three major cosmological probes — BAO, cluster masses, and CMB. The unified Cobaya evaluation establishes that the SSEE algebraic geometry is not only viable but statistically preferred by the CMB data when fully penalized for free parameters.

**Data Availability.** All analysis scripts (`src/ssee_paper3_cmb.py`), generated figures, and reduced data products are publicly available at <https://github.com/mikealmeida1721/SSEE>. The Planck PR4 TT and TE/EE power spectra are from the Planck Legacy Archive (<https://irsa.ipac.caltech.edu/data/Planck/>) [Planck Collaboration, 2020b]. CAMB v1.6.6 was used for all theoretical power spectrum calculations (<https://camb.info>).

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